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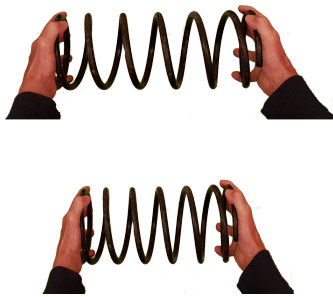
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Quantity of information

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Problem: Can we define the quantity of information contained in a single, isolated object?

Information is what is left when any redundancy has been removed. Kolmogorov complexity does exactly that: It removes redundancy by performing ideal compression (without loss). The output represents the irreducible information contained in the object.



Information as compression



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the same information as x.

We can measure this information by the length of $ZC(x)$, which is $C(x)$.

Conclusion:

Information, defined as the size of what is left after having removed all redundancy though compression, coincides with Kolmogorov complexity.

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